

Phishing Red Flags Checklist

Header mismatches

- Does the Reply-To address match the From domain? If not, be suspicious.
- Does Return-Path point somewhere unrelated to the claimed sender?
- Is the display name trustworthy but the actual email address odd?

Message pressure tactics

- Urgency: "act within 24 hours" or "your account will be locked."
- Authority: impersonating IT, HR, or a executive.
- A link that asks you to "verify" or "re-enter" credentials.

Before you click anything

- Hover the link and check where it actually points, not just the display text.
- Contact the sender through a separate, known channel to confirm.
- When in doubt, report it to your security team instead of clicking.